Investigation report

Monthly active users across available months

How did monthly active users change across the available months?

Data

PocketToons synthetic reference fixture
April–September 2026, UTC

Snapshot

SHA-256 verified (see scope)
Build
3a0dbed21d2f45958aefa2887a0cadd8

Run

Independent
2026-11-09
6 read-only checks

Table of contents

Monthly active users

01 The answer 3

02 How we investigated 4

03 What happened 4

05 Data quality and limits 4

06 What to do next 5

A Evidence appendix 5

How to read this report

- Checks refer to numbered evidence JSONL files in the run folder.
- MAU counts distinct identified people, not sessions; unidentified sessions are shown separately.

Terms used in this report

Term	Meaning
MAU	Distinct resolved users with a session active during a complete UTC calendar month.
Unidentified sessions	Sessions that cannot be attributed under the approved identity rule; excluded from MAU.

01. Chapter

The answer

01

Monthly active users rose in every available month, from 7,937 in April to 11,447 in September 2026: an increase of 3,510 users (44.2%). Growth slowed to 1.6% in July before accelerating in August. (Check 4)

Month 2026	MAU	Change vs prior	Unidentified sessions
Apr	7,937	—	2,286
May	9,134	+1,197 (+15.1%)	3,044
Jun	9,976	+842 (+9.2%)	3,184
Jul	10,138	+162 (+1.6%)	3,354
Aug	10,871	+733 (+7.2%)	3,480
Sep	11,447	+576 (+5.3%)	3,703

Interpretation These figures describe the trend, not its causes. Unidentified sessions are excluded and do not translate directly into a number of missing people.

Data snapshot SHA-256 verified (see scope) · build 3a0dbed21d2f45958aefa2887a0cadd8 · 6 read-only checks

02. Chapter
How we investigated
02

What data we used

- **Period:** six complete UTC calendar months, April through September 2026; coverage ends 2026-10-01 00:00 UTC, exclusive.
- **Definition:** approved mau v1.1; a user is active if a resolved session overlaps the month, including browsing-only activity.
- **Snapshot:** SHA-256 8d39e78bbaa756b594c9e38797490dc1879f2980a05f966aaf62d3919517790b.
- **Build:** 3a0dbed21d2f45958aefa2887a0cadd8, succeeded 2026-11-09 11:16:56 UTC. Checks 1–4.

Investigation path

- Selected Gold monthly KPI because its grain, UTC coverage and MAU definition match the question.
- Checked build reconciliation and independently recounted monthly distinct users from Silver; all six values match. (Checks 2, 4, 6)
- Checked session identity, duplicates and spans in Silver. (Check 5)

03. Chapter
What happened
03

The movement

- Month-on-month changes: May +1,197 (15.1%); June +842 (9.2%); July +162 (1.6%); August +733 (7.2%); September +576 (5.3%).
- MAU is non-additive: do not sum monthly counts to obtain unique users across the period.

05. Chapter
Data quality and limits
05

Data quality

- Unidentified sessions range from 2,286 to 3,703 per month and are excluded from MAU; their number of distinct people and effect on the trend are unknown. (Check 4)
- Session-start check found no duplicate IDs, invalid spans or identity-link mismatches. One session spanning August and September explains why September has 3,702 unresolved sessions started in September but 3,703 touching September. (Checks 4–5)
- The build records successful source-to-Gold MAU reconciliation and mau v1.1. Its registry file SHA-256 differs from the current registry file, so exact registry-file equivalence is unverified despite the matching version label. The builder hash matches the current builder. (Check 2)

Limitations

- The dataset is synthetic; its activity coverage is declared complete for the fixture, not evidence of real-world completeness.
- The trend alone does not establish why MAU changed. No causal hypotheses were tested for this descriptive question.

06. Chapter

What to do next

06

01 If an explanation is needed, investigate acquisition and retention using the approved growth-accounting definition and check whether excluded unidentified traffic changes interpretation.

Appendix

Evidence appendix

A

Check	Purpose	Evidence file
1	Layer inventory	01_objects.jsonl
2	Build and reconciliation	02_build.jsonl
3	Dataset metadata	03_metadata.jsonl
4	Gold monthly MAU	04_monthly.jsonl
5	Session quality	05_quality.jsonl
6	Silver MAU recount	06_recount.jsonl